

1. I spend north of 15,000 a month and this is the only card I'll have. So I'll be using it extensively.
2. I'll set up an automatic transfer from my checking account to pay your bills 3 days prior to due date. That takes away any uncertainty of payment.
3. I chose you because your customer service is good. Now I have seen the other bank's card and they don't have a joining fee. I'd hate to transfer my interests for something as small as this.

Rep : I'll check in with my superior on this.

You: Sure, I'll wait.

Rep: It seems we can make an exception and waive the joining fee. BAM

Negotiate on facts and not on interests. Most of the time the fee gets waived but sometimes they play hardball. It's totally understandable as a senior might have briefed them to cut down on rebates and refunds that morning. In that case, ask to be transferred to the supervisor and explain it, one more time.

But if the rewards outweigh the fees, I keep mum and stop negotiating. You'd want a cordial relationship as you'll be talking with them quite often in the future. After talking with any representative, I take their name and record the details of the call onto an excel sheet. It is not significant right now but 6 years down the line, when you're a loyal customer, you can track all the promises offered and negotiate with zeal. In fact, you can bring the foreign currency commission to 0% or something similarly extraordinary because you were a loyal customer who paid his bills on time and are a favorite with the reps.

Remember the Rewards